

01 — Vision & Definition

One-line definition

BarrioRed is community digital infrastructure that democratizes commercial visibility and strengthens the social fabric in popular-economy neighborhoods.

"Infraestructura digital comunitaria que democratiza la visibilidad comercial y fortalece el tejido social en barrios de economía popular."

It is **hyperlocal, multi-tenant, replicable, and low-cost** — designed to launch one neighborhood at a time and scale by copying the model, not by building bespoke systems each time.

The problem

In popular-economy neighborhoods, thousands of small and informal businesses — tiendas, peluquerías, talleres, comidas, services run from a living room — are economically real but **digitally invisible**. They:

- Don't appear on Google Maps, delivery apps, or directories.
- Can't meet the requirements (RUT, Cámara de Comercio, bank accounts, formal addresses) that mainstream platforms assume.
- Compete for attention they can't afford to buy.
- Are disconnected from one another and from neighborhood information (alerts, events, services).

At the same time, **residents** lack a single trustworthy place to find what's near them, know what's happening in the barrio, buy and sell locally, and reach emergency or public services.

The result: economic value stays trapped, and the social fabric that holds these neighborhoods together has no digital home.

The solution

A single neighborhood platform with four pillars, plus the connective tissue (auth, profiles, maps, notifications) that ties them together:

1. **Directorio** — a directory of local businesses, including informal ones, with profiles, photos, hours, location, and a WhatsApp-first contact.
2. **Comunidad (Red Vecinal)** — a neighborhood board for announcements, alerts (water cuts, security, construction), local events, and jobs.
3. **Marketplace (Clasificados)** — local buy/sell classifieds between neighbors.
4. **Servicios** — a curated directory of public services, emergency contacts, transport, and government procedures.

Everything is **WhatsApp-first, mobile-first**, and built to work for people on low-end phones and limited data.

Mission & vision

- **Mission:** Give every neighborhood business and resident a dignified digital presence and a shared local network — regardless of formality, income, or tech literacy.
- **Vision:** A replicable network of neighborhood platforms across Colombia's popular economy, where local commerce is visible, neighbors are connected, and value created in the barrio stays in the barrio.

Core values

- **Dignity over charity.** Merchants and residents are protagonists and clients, not "beneficiaries."
- **Inclusion by design.** No RUT, no Cámara de Comercio, no formal requirements for basic participation.
- **Hyperlocal trust.** Depth in one neighborhood beats thin coverage of a whole city.
- **Low cost, high leverage.** Lean infrastructure, replicable architecture, sustainable economics.
- **Community first, monetization second.** Revenue funds the mission; it never crowds out access.

Key differentiators (protect these)

1. **Informal business inclusion** — the on-ramp competitors structurally exclude.
2. **WhatsApp-first** — WhatsApp is the primary call-to-action, not phone calls or websites, because that's how the neighborhood already transacts.
3. **Hyperlocal focus** — one comuna at a time, not city-wide noise.
4. **Multi-tenant & replicable** — built from day one to host many neighborhoods (barriored.co/{neighborhood}).
5. **Low cost** — runs on lean, mostly free-tier infrastructure, keeping it viable for low-income markets.

Pilot

- **Where:** Parque Industrial, Comuna del Café, Pereira, Risaralda, Colombia.
- **Scale of opportunity:** 30,000+ inhabitants in the area.
- **Why here:** A dense popular-economy neighborhood with abundant informal commerce, strong community identity, and clear gaps in digital visibility and local information.

Elevator pitches

- **For a merchant:** *"Pon tu negocio en el mapa del barrio — gratis, sin papeles, y con botón directo a tu WhatsApp."*
- **For a resident:** *"Todo tu barrio en un solo lugar: negocios, anuncios, alertas, lo que se vende y los servicios que necesitas."*
- **For a partner/investor:** "BarrioRed is replicable digital infrastructure for Colombia's popular economy — we make informal commerce visible and connect neighbors, one neighborhood at a time, on a low-cost multi-tenant platform."